Answers and talk notes

Math is Mine

What your student is learning

Tonight we talk about being a doer of math. A doer of math is anyone who uses math thinking — which is everyone, every day. We also practice estimating: giving a reasoned answer that is close enough to be useful.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** Estimate. Estimate: a reasoned answer that is close enough to be useful, often written with the word 'about'.
2. **A.** 20. There are 5 equal groups of about 4 people, so 5 × 4 = 20 people.
3. **C.** 30 + 6. 30 + 6 = 36. The 3 is in the tens place, so it is worth 30, and the 6 is 6 ones.
4. **D.** 48. 6 shelves with about 8 books each is 6 × 8 = 48 books.
5. **B.** 1,000. 40 rows of about 25 seats is 40 × 25 = 1,000 seats.
6. **C.** 108. 9 scoops of 12 peas is 9 × 12 = 108 peas.

Talk about it

What small group did you count, and how did you decide how many of those groups fill the whole thing?

Home mission

Pick a full drawer or bag at home. Ask your student to count one small handful first. Then ask: about how many handfuls fill it? Let your student be the teacher and explain the estimate.

When they are stuck, ask

- What is one small group you can count?
- How many groups like that fit in the whole thing?
- Tell me one time you used math outside of school.

Try not to say

- Just guess a number.
- Count every single one — that is the only way.
- You are just not a math person.